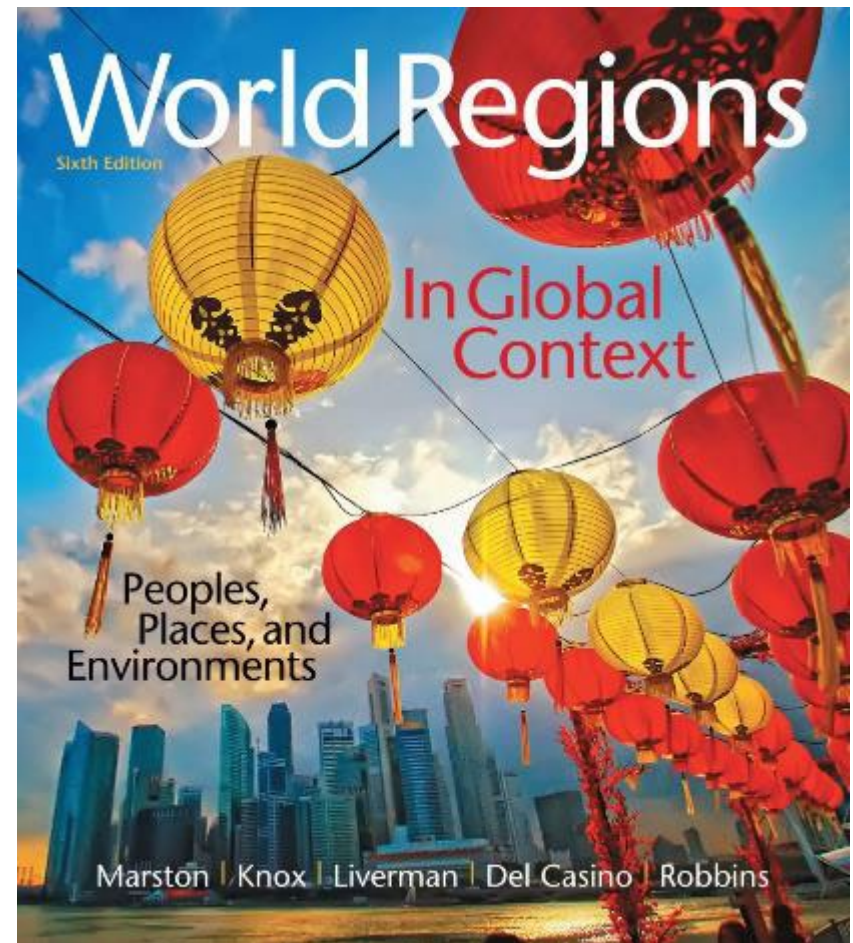


World Regions in Global Context: Peoples, Places, and Environments

6th Edition

The United States and Canada

Lectures by:
Christa Ann Smith



Learning Outcomes

- Describe the distinctive landscapes of the United States and Canada with respect to landforms and climate.
- Explain how the United States and Canada are affecting and affected by global climate change.
- Understand the rise of the United States and Canada as key forces in the global economy.
- Describe how the two countries' dynamic economies contribute to and shape the global economy.
- Summarize the economic inequality that exists in both the United States and Canada.

Learning Outcomes

- Compare and contrast the forms and practice of government of the United States and Canada.
- Summarize the indigenous and immigrant histories of the United States and Canada.
- Describe the fundamentals of the geography of religion and language across the United States and Canada.
- Compare and contrast the urbanization processes that have shaped the United States and Canada.

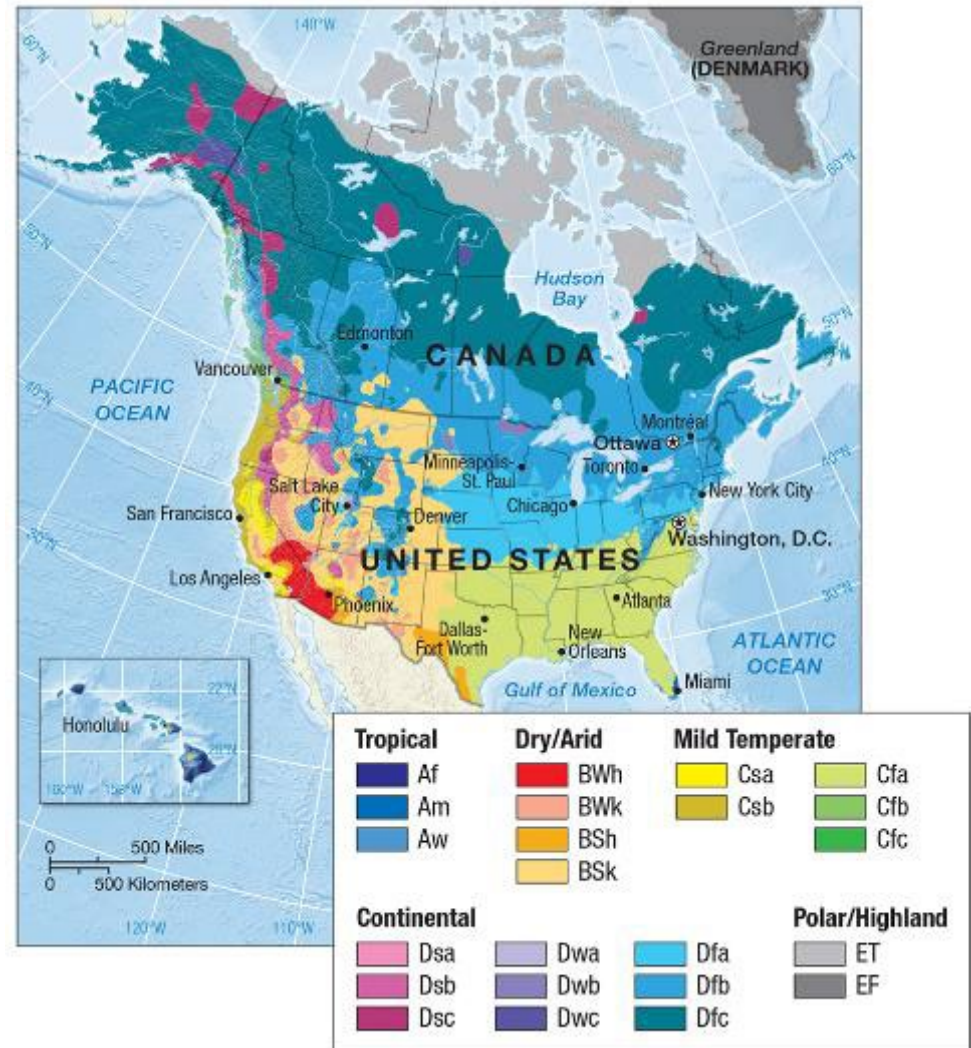
The United States and Canada

- Highly developed region
- Large landmass
- Human adaptation environment



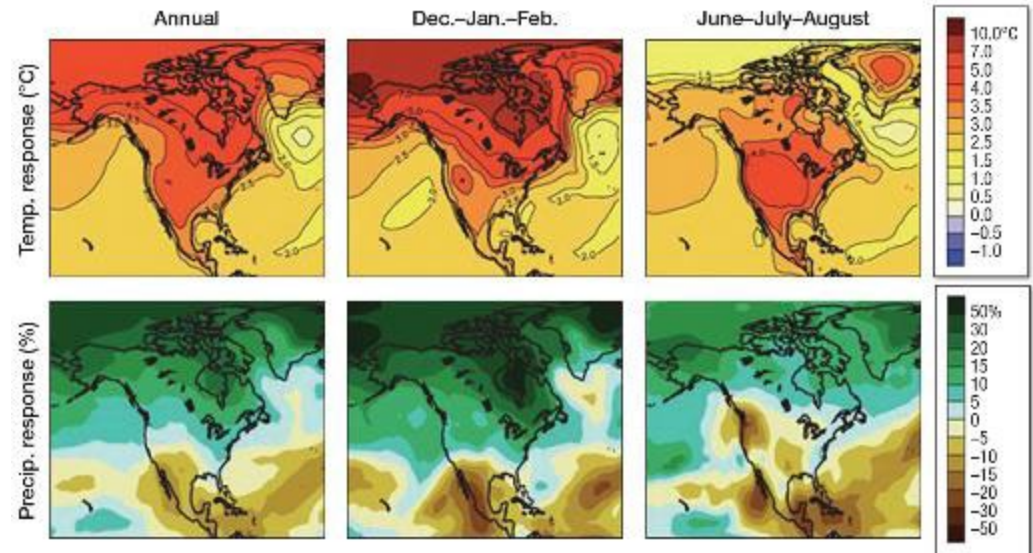
Climate, Adaptation, and Global Change

- Nearly every climate pattern
 - Arctic north
 - Southeast United States
 - Precipitation gradient
 - Jet stream in winter months
 - “Lake-effect” snow



Climate, Adaptation, and Global Change (cont.)

- Environmental modifications
 - resource wealth
 - technological capability for exploitation
- Environmental impacts
 - global climate change
 - **greenhouse gases**
 - **large carbon footprint**



Geological Resources, Risk, and Water

- Canadian Shield
- Interior lowlands
- Great Plains
- Rocky Mountains
- Appalachian Mountains
- Atlantic Coastal Plain
- River and lake systems

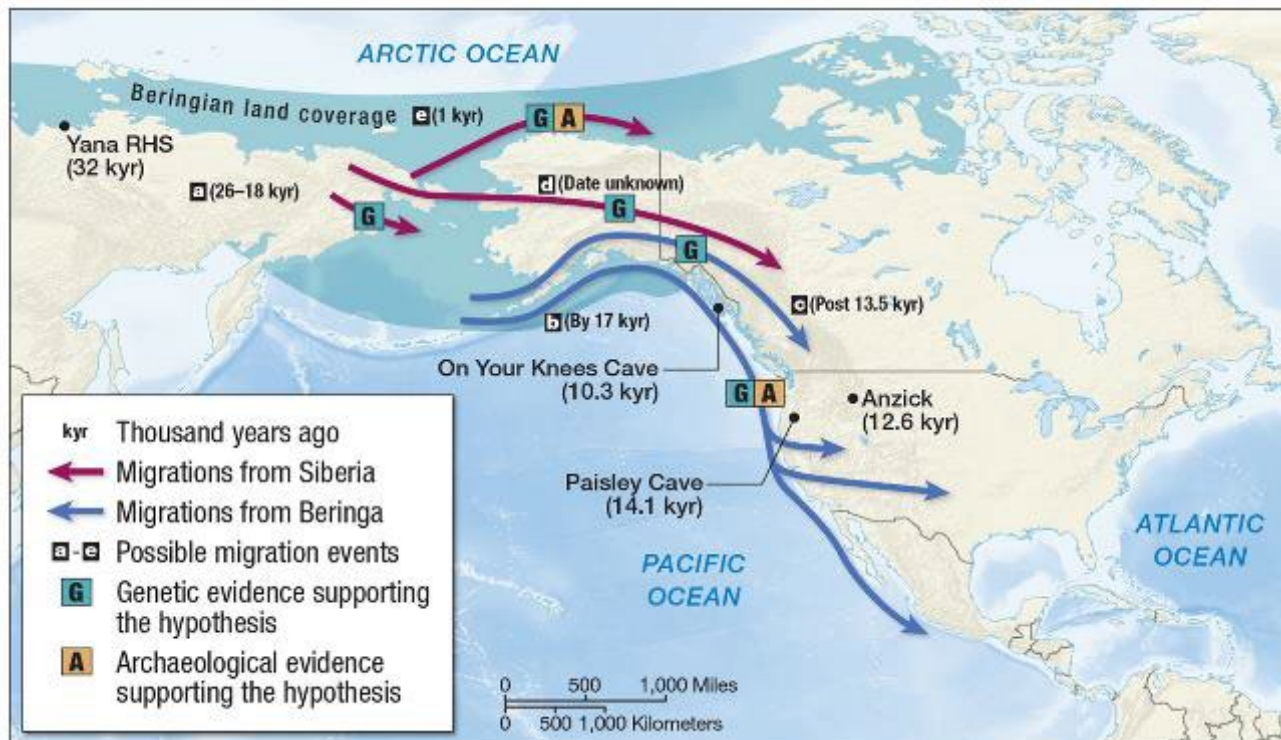


Geological Resources, Risk, and Water (cont.)

- Energy and mineral resources
- Countries top producers of natural gas
 - substantial coal and oil reserves
 - renewable sources

Ecology, Land, and Environmental Management

- Indigenous land use
 - land bridge
 - subsistence production
 - plant domestication



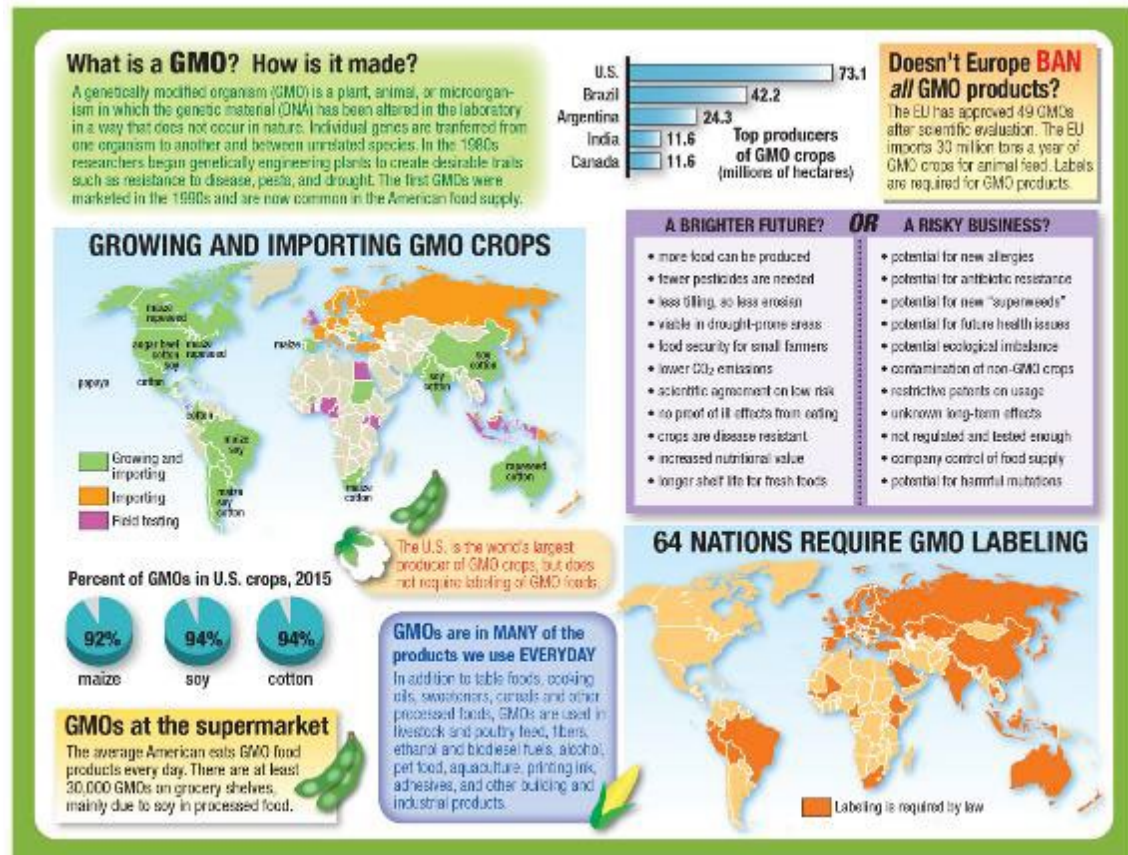
Ecology, Land, and Environmental Management (cont.)

- Colonial land use
 - resource commodification
 - land ownership
 - **reservation/reserve**
- irrigation
- **acid rain**
- green goods and services
- **cap and trade programs**



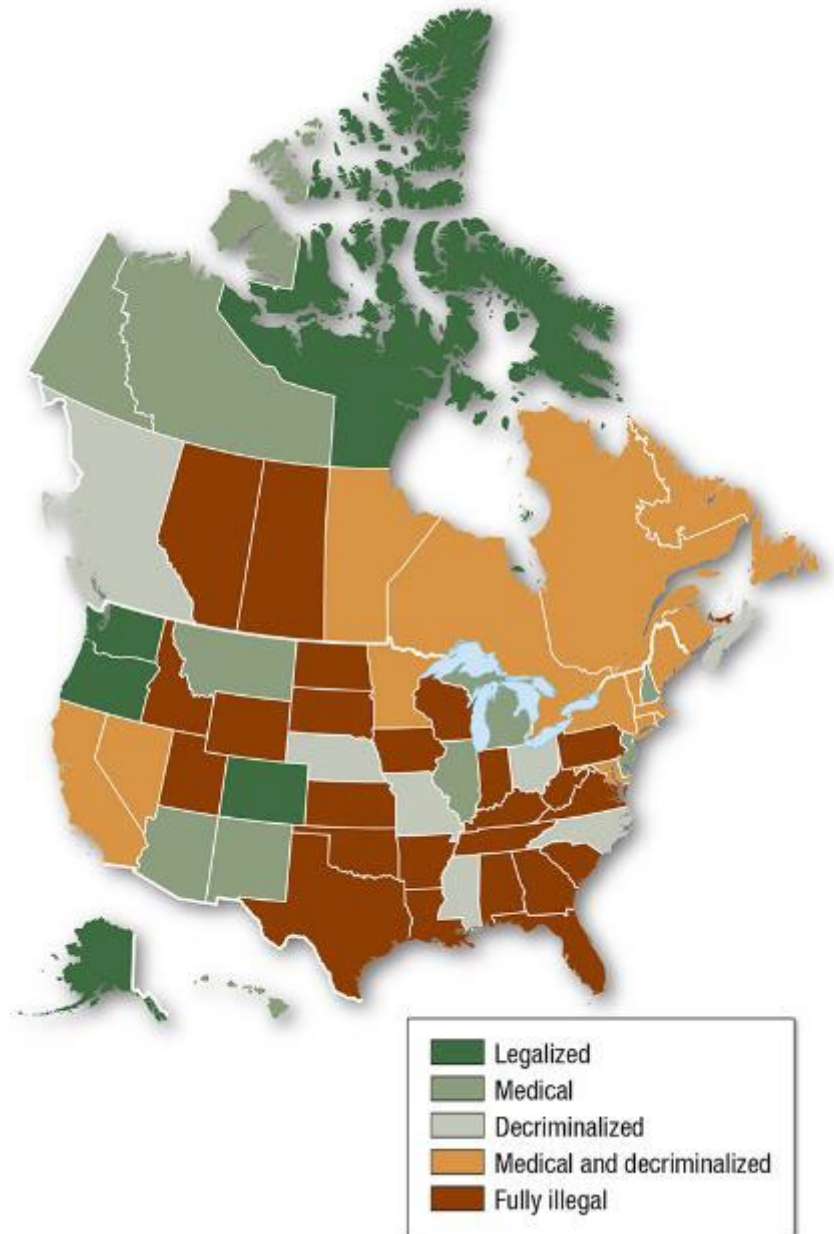
Ecology, Land, and Environmental Management (cont.)

- Alternative food movements
 - organic farming
 - genetically modified organisms (GMOs)
 - local food
 - slow food



Geographies of Indulgence, Desire, and Addiction

- Marijuana is the most commonly used illicit substance
- Use is higher in developed countries
- California and British Columbia
- Legalization and interdiction



History, Economy, and Territory/Historical Landscapes

- Indigenous histories
 - wide range of cultural groups
 - daily life governed by tribe and environment
 - Europeans initially interested in commerce



Historical Landscapes (cont.)

- Colonization and independence
 - **Europeanization**
 - Great Britain dominant
 - exploitation of native people
 - **French and Indian War**
 - **American Revolution**



Historical Landscapes (cont.)

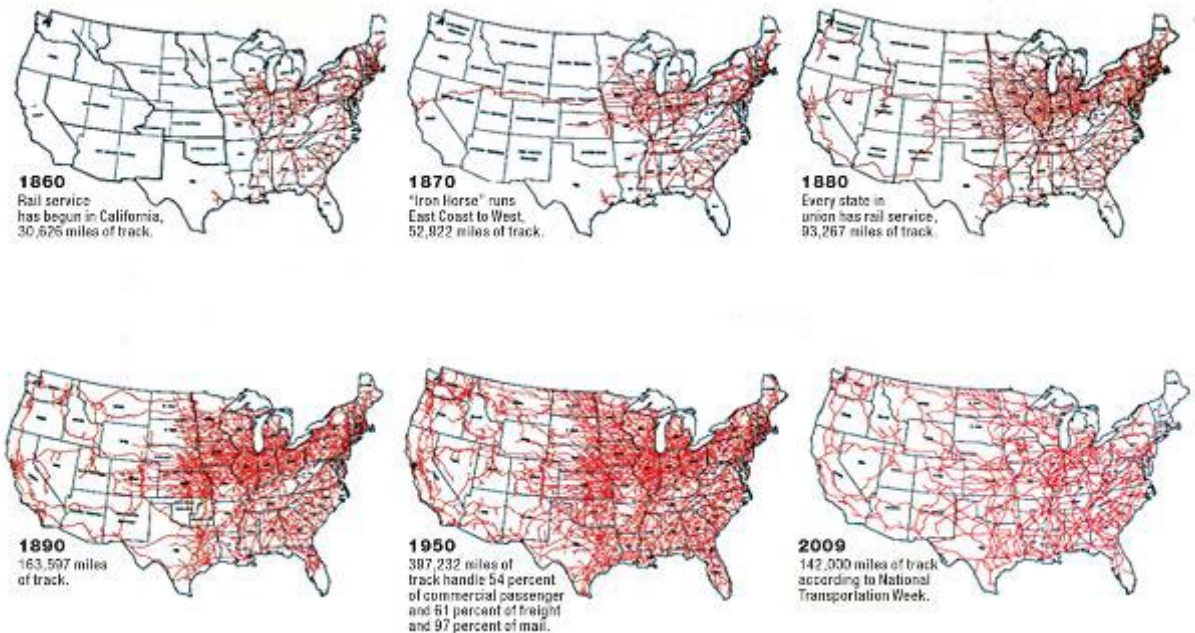
- Legacy of slavery
 - different development for the U.S. North and South
 - **indentured servants**
 - reduction of native populations
 - Atlantic slave trade

Historical Landscapes (cont.)

- Settlement and industrialization
 - continuous frontier settlement
 - westward expansion in Canada
 - industrialization of northeast United States
 - **U.S. Civil War**
 - **North America Act of 1867**

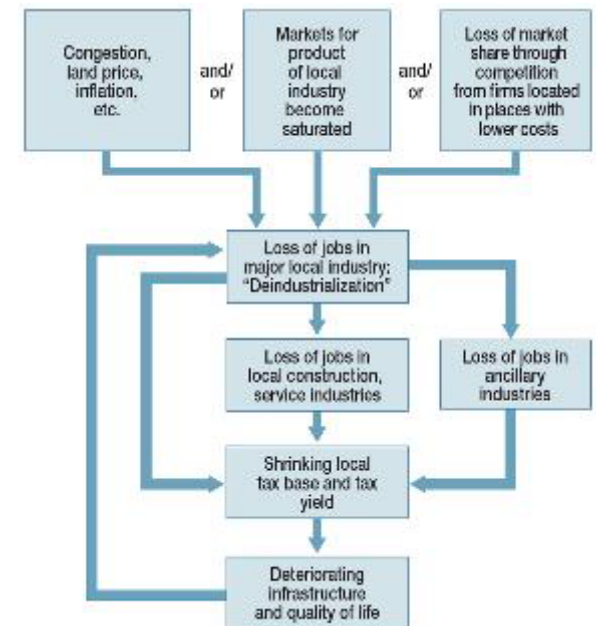
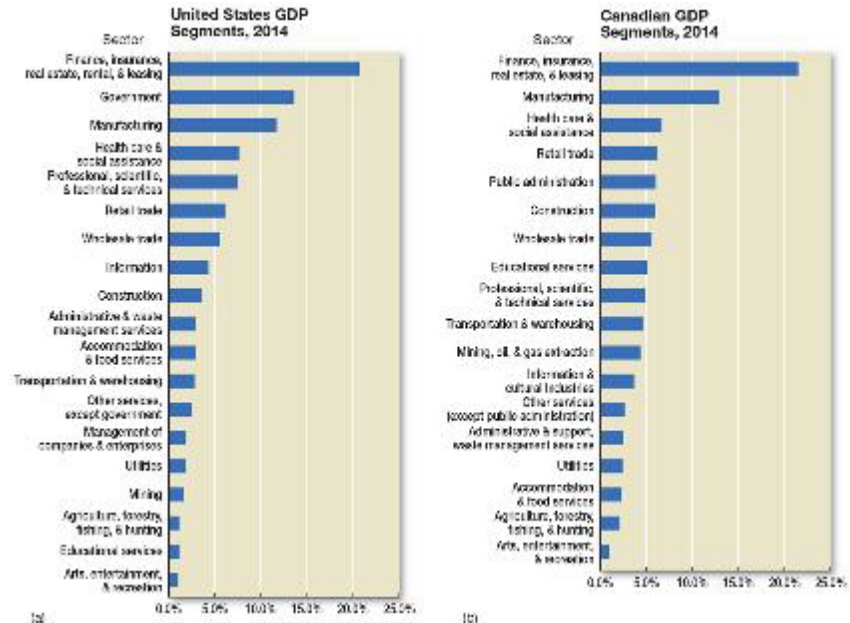
Economy, Accumulation, and the Production of Inequality

- Two economies
 - Canada
 - **staples economy**
 - United States
 - far dominant



Economy, Accumulation, and the Production of Inequality (cont.)

- Transforming economies
 - Manufacturing Belt
 - Rustbelt
 - deindustrialization
 - Sunbelt
 - creative destruction
- The new economy
 - information technologies
 - Canada's role



- **Wealth inequality**
- **Income inequality**
- **Occupy Wall Street**



Economy, Accumulation, and the Production of Inequality (cont.)

- Global economic crisis
 - bank failures in 2008
 - personal and government debt
 - mortgage crisis
 - signs of recovery
 - effects on Canada's economy

Visualizing Geography

- The gender pay gap in the United States and Canada
 - women earn 77 cents for every one dollar a man earns
 - pay gap worse for minorities

The Gender Pay Gap in the United States and Canada

Income inequality based on gender in both the United States and Canada, as elsewhere in the world, favors men over women. The "pay gap" as it is called, has been an enduring feature of both economies since women joined the work force in large numbers.

"For every one dollar a man earns in the U.S. and Canada, a woman who works the same job full time earns 77 cents."

FIGURE 63.1 The gender pay gap in the United States.



Public and private sector = 77
There is a wide difference in pay between men and women in the United States as it adds up. In an average person's life time that's that's enough money to...

Historically and in the future, women tend to be considered secondary earners in a traditional male dominated household. The assumption is that women need less pay as the male breadwinner's paycheck covers family expenses. Unfortunately, then and now, this assumption is only partially true and moreover, reflects acceptance of a belief that an equally qualified female in the same job is somehow worth less than her male counterpart.

- Buy a house in the U.S.
- + Put two kids through college at a public school
- + Buy 21,000 gallons of gas
- + Feed a family of four for 64 years

Over the course of her career, a typical woman working full time in the U.S. and Canada will lose

\$431,000

In the United States and Canada over the years and now the numerous federal legislation has helped to narrow that gap. Solutions offered to close the pay gap include improved policies that support mothers, better pay and benefits, reduce occupational segregation by gender and enforce existing laws.

FIGURE 63.2 The gender pay gap in Canada.



Public sector = 82 cents

Private sector = 73

The pay gap is worse for minorities, both men and women, than it is for majority women. In Ontario, minority and Aboriginal women earn much less than white men.



Minority women = 64



Aboriginal women = 46

In Canada, gender discrimination in compensation is being addressed both federally and provincially.

- Compare and contrast the economies of one city in Canada and one in the United States, referring to each city's website.
- Find data on median income levels and cost of living for both cities and draw a conclusion between the city and individual economies.

Territory and Politics

- **Democracies**
- **State and government**
 - **federal system**
 - differences in the American and Canadian constitutions
 - social welfare
 - creation of Nunavut

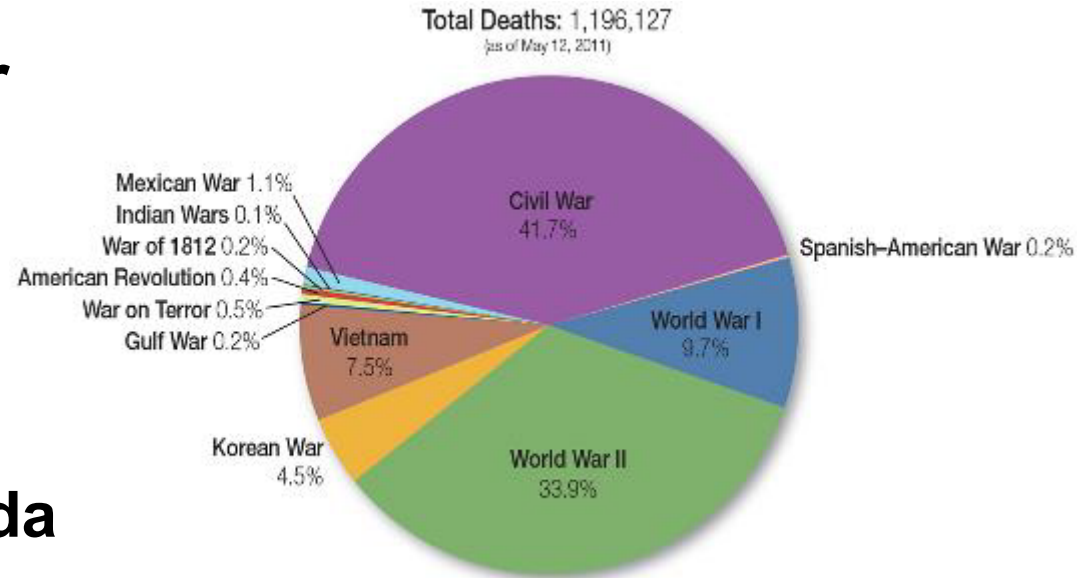
Territory and Politics (cont.)

- U.S. political and military influence
 - Monroe Doctrine
 - “America First”
 - post-WWII
 - end of the Cold War

Territory and Politics (cont.)

- **U.S. War on Terror**

- invasion of Afghanistan
- Iraq and Saddam Hussein
- Taliban and **al-Qaeda**
- high cost of the war



Territory and Politics (cont.)

- Social movements
 - women's movement
 - Seneca Falls, NY (1848)
 - gays, disabled, children's rights
 - environmental movement

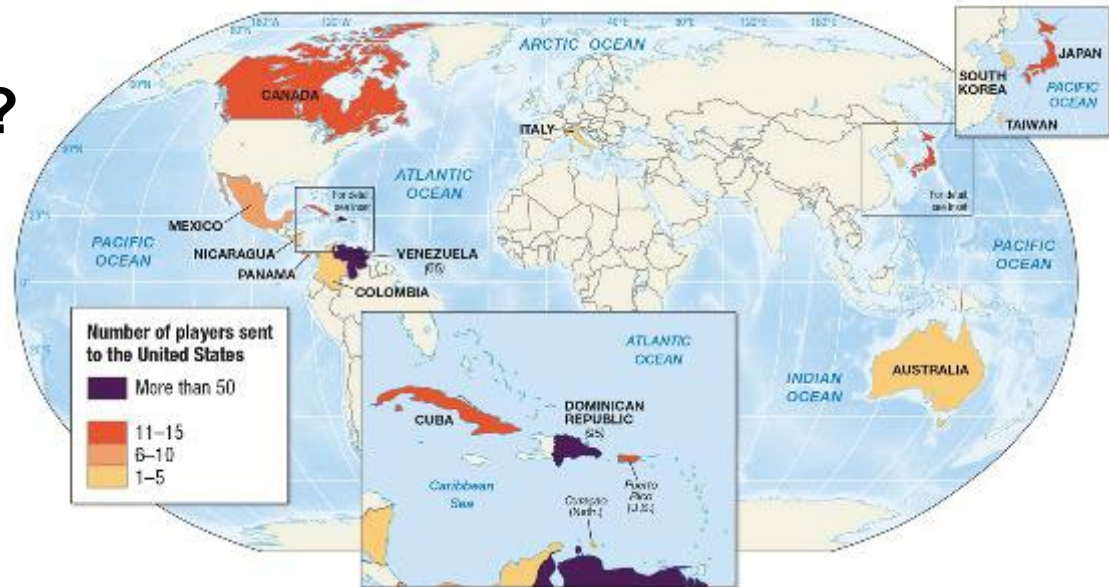


Culture and Populations/Religion and Language

- United States
 - predominantly English
 - Roman Catholics and Protestants
 - regional differences
 - **Bible Belt**
 - **assimilation**
- Canada
 - French and English
 - **multiculturalism**

Cultural Practices, Social Differences, and Identity

- Arts, music, and sports
 - jazz
 - Native American art
 - baseball
- U.S. cultural imperialism
 - globalization or **Americanization?**



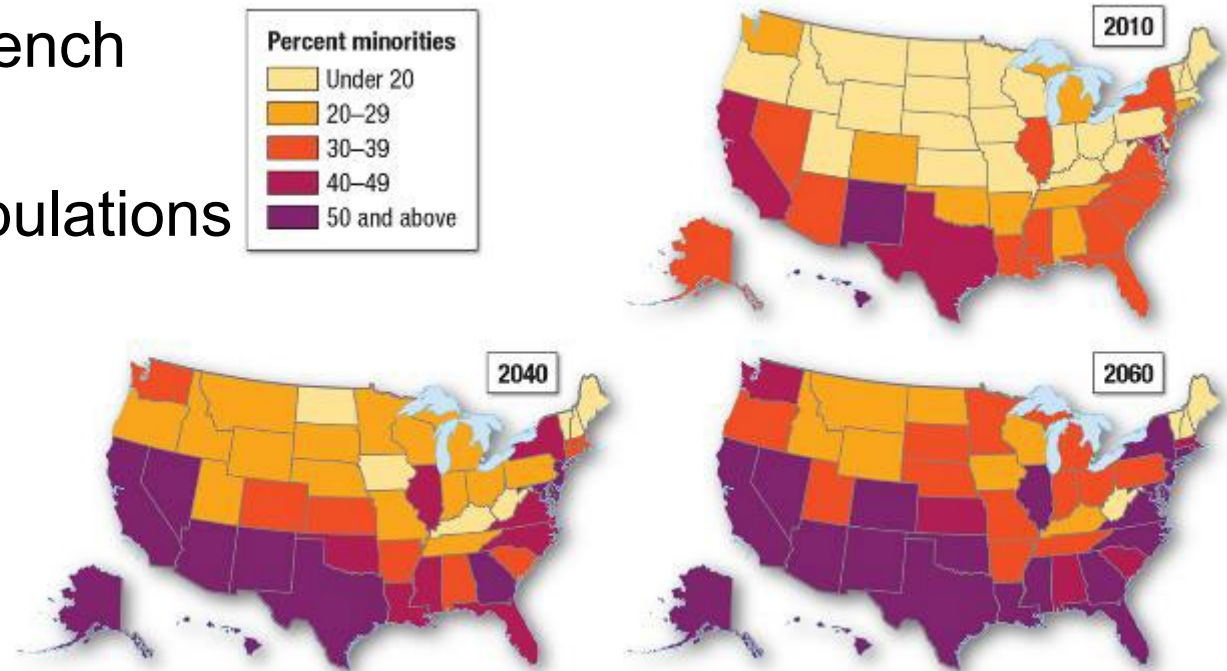
Cultural Practices, Social Differences, and Identity (cont.)

- Cultural nationalism
 - protection against American cultural invasion
 - export of music and film personalities to the United States
- Sex, gender, and **sexuality**
 - Civil Marriage Act



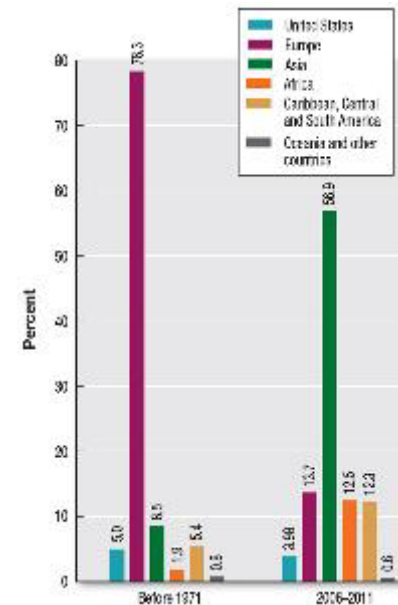
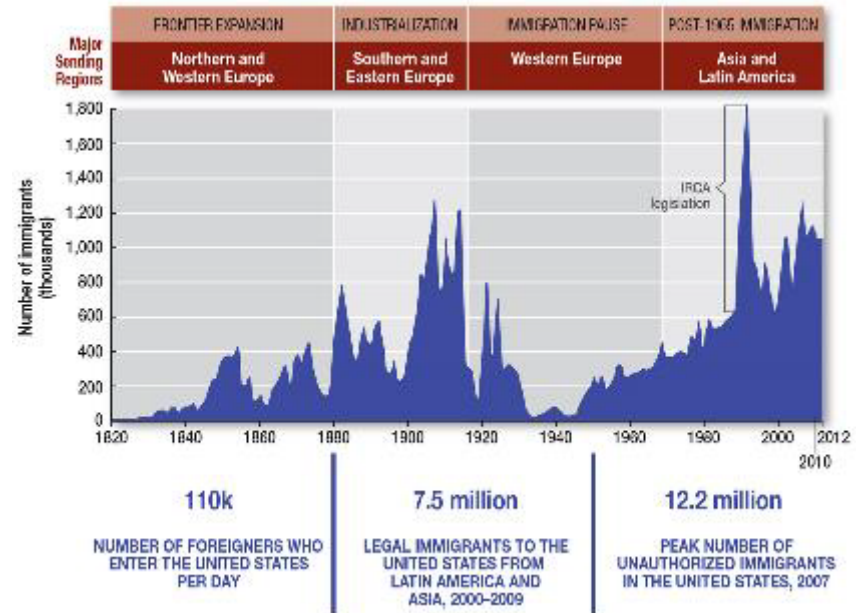
Demography and Urbanization

- United States
 - whites make up $\frac{3}{4}$ of total
 - minorities have higher fertility
 - Hispanics largest minority
- Canada
 - British and French descendants
 - immigrant populations



Demography and Urbanization (cont.)

- Immigration
 - United States
 - first wave
 - second wave
 - third wave
 - Canada
 - French settlers
 - resistance to immigrants
 - hate crimes



Demography and Urbanization (cont.)

- Urbanization and industrialization
 - indigenous cities
 - European settlements
 - commercial centers
 - pull of manufacturing jobs
- Suburbanization
 - reasons for moving out of the city



Future Geographies

- U.S. dominance and challenge
 - 2008 recession
 - China challenge
- Security, terrorism, and war
 - ISIS
- Environmental change
 - significant effects, but localized variations



End of Chapter 6